

F5 Daily Briefing — Monday, May 11, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

17

ANNOUNCEMENTS

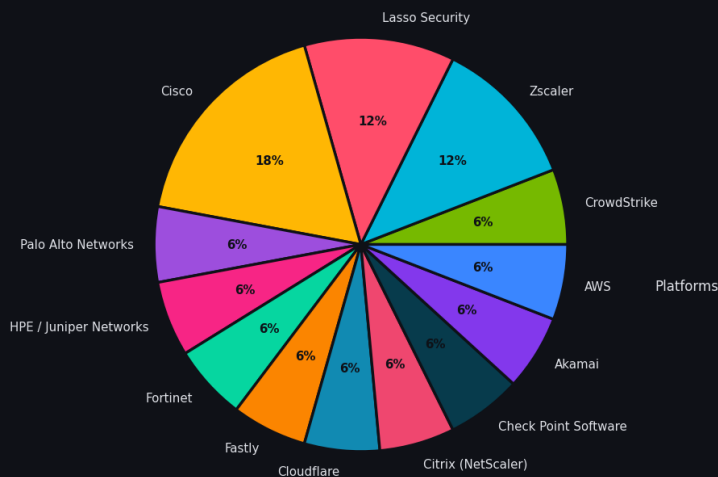
13

ACTIVE

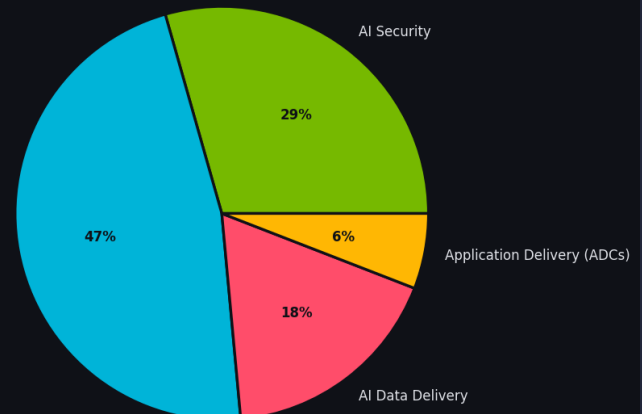
4

ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (17)

PARTNERSHIP EXPANSION

CrowdStrike

2026-05-10

AI Security

CrowdStrike Expands AI Security Reach via Project QuiltWorks and Falcon OverWatch for Defender

CrowdStrike expanded its AI security footprint with two announcements highlighted in coverage over the weekend. Project QuiltWorks added seven new global partners — Armadin, Cognizant, HCLTech, Infosys, KPMG, NTT DATA, TCS, and Wipro — to integrate Falcon across enterprise consulting channels and apply frontier AI for risk assessment and remediation. CrowdStrike also rolled out Falcon OverWatch for Defender, bringing expert-led threat hunting and Threat AI to Microsoft Defender endpoints without requiring tool replacement. Together the moves signal a partner-centric, ecosystem-driven AI security growth strategy, with early QuiltWorks results showing tens of millions of vulnerabilities found at Fortune 100 customers.

Source: <https://finance.yahoo.com/markets/stocks/articles/crowdstrike-expands-ai-security-reach-200654032.html>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

Zscaler

2026-05-09

Platforms

Zscaler Launches Cellular Zero-Trust IoT Security Amid 387% Surge in Critical-Infrastructure Attacks

Zscaler launched Zscaler Cellular, a zero-trust IoT/OT security solution that uses cellular SIMs to securely connect edge devices without agents or VPNs. The product targets rising risk in critical infrastructure following a 387% surge in attacks on the energy sector and a 45% rise in IoT malware. Early validation comes from Sandvik, with Zscaler positioning Cellular as an infrastructure play to extend its Zero Trust Exchange platform into IoT/OT revenue. Analysts noted competition from Palo Alto Networks' unified SASE, but Zscaler argues its cellular-native zero-trust rails are foundational for connected-device and remote deployment scale.

Source: <https://www.ainvest.com/news/zscaler-cellular-bet-monetizing-387-surge-critical-iot-attacks-2605/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Lasso Security**

2026-05-09

AI Security

Lasso Launches GitHub Integration to Shift AI Security Left

Lasso Security announced a new GitHub integration that shifts AI security left by analyzing codebases at the source to identify AI primitives, models, MCP servers, tools, and agentic components. The integration builds a Security Graph mapping AI interactions, data flows, and trust relationships, transforming AI security from reactive alerting into a continuous, graph-based view of where models connect to data and where misconfigurations or excessive autonomy exist. The capability flags prompt-injection sinks, unexpected RCE paths, shadow AI, and MCP proliferation early, supporting risk-based prioritization within CI/CD workflows.

Source: <https://www.lasso.security/blog/shift-left-ai-security-github-integration>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Lasso Security**

2026-05-09

AI Security

Lasso Adds Native AI Agent Discovery Across AWS, Azure, Google Cloud, and Salesforce

Lasso Security rolled out native AI agent discovery across major cloud platforms including AWS Bedrock, Microsoft Azure AI Foundry, Microsoft Copilot Studio, Google Vertex AI, and Salesforce Agentforce. The new integrations automatically discover, inventory, and profile every AI agent across engineering, business units, and third-party tools, including low-code/no-code agents and those built natively inside cloud environments without managed AI services. For each discovered agent, Lasso generates an AI Bill of Materials covering model and version, system prompts, connected tools, APIs, retrieval sources, guardrails, orchestration framework, and full dependency set — positioning discovery as the first step in Lasso's AI security lifecycle.

Source: <https://www.lasso.security/blog/ai-agent-discovery-across-cloud-platforms>

OPEN SOURCE RELEASE**Cisco**

2026-05-09

AI Security

Cisco Releases Open-Source "DNA Test for AI Models" Evaluation Framework

Cisco released an open-source framework dubbed the "DNA Test for AI Models," designed to evaluate and characterize AI models for security-relevant properties. The release continues Cisco's push to provide enterprises with practical tooling for AI model validation, complementing its AI Defense platform and broader AI security strategy. Cisco positions the framework as a community resource to help organizations assess models before production deployment, addressing growing demand for transparent model evaluation amid rapidly evolving frontier models.

Source: https://www.newslocker.com/en-us/profession/news_ict/cisco-releases-open-source-dna-test-for-ai-models/

STRATEGY UPDATE**Zscaler**

2026-05-08

Platforms

Zscaler CXO Roundup Highlights Frontier-AI Threat Strategy and Project Glasswing Partnership

Zscaler's May CXO Monthly Roundup outlined the company's evolving response to frontier AI threats. CEO Jay Chaudhry detailed a partnership with Project Glasswing for early access to Anthropic's Claude Mythos Preview, used to harden Zscaler's platform and applications. Chaudhry warned that emerging models like GPT-5.5 and Mythos-class capabilities could accelerate zero-day exploitation and shrink attacker workflows. Zscaler urged customers to reimagine secure SDLC tooling with frontier models and minimize external attack surface via Zero Trust Architecture. The roundup also flagged BlackBasta ransomware activity, fake Adobe downloads delivering ScreenConnect, and nation-state abuse of GitHub for C2.

Source: <https://www.zscaler.com/blogs/cxo-insights/zscaler-cxo-monthly-roundup-april-2026>

SECURITY ADVISORY**Palo Alto Networks****2026-05-08****Platforms**

Critical PAN-OS Captive Portal Vulnerability (CVE-2026-0300) Added to CISA KEV List

A critical buffer overflow in Palo Alto Networks PAN-OS Captive Portal (CVE-2026-0300, CVSS 9.3) allows unauthenticated remote code execution with root privileges on exposed PA-Series and VM-Series firewalls. CISA added the flaw to the Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalog on May 7, and Unit 42 attributes active exploitation to threat cluster CL-STA-1132, with shellcode injections targeting nginx and attempts to erase forensic logs suggesting state-sponsored involvement. Affected branches include PAN-OS 10.2, 11.1, 11.2, and 12.1; Cloud NGFW, Prisma Access, and Panorama are unaffected. Palo Alto urges customers to restrict portal exposure and apply patches as they roll out in May.

Source: <https://www.hexnode.com/blogs/palo-alto-captive-portal-exploit-exposes-firewall-trust-risks/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**HPE / Juniper Networks****2026-05-08****AI Data Delivery**

HPE Launches First Juniper x Aruba Integrated Product: Self-Driving Wi-Fi 7 With Marvis AI

HPE unveiled its first integrated Juniper x Aruba product following the 2025 acquisition: the HPE Networking 723H Wi-Fi 7 access point with AI-powered autonomous operations. Manageable via Aruba Central or the Mist platform with Marvis AI, the three-radio AP is targeted at hospitality, branch, and teleworker deployments. AI-driven features include RF environment scanning to avoid frequencies used by priority bands, dynamic capacity optimization for events, self-driving VLAN validation with traffic-loss prevention, and rogue DHCP detection and mitigation. The launch demonstrates HPE's cross-pollination strategy — combining decades of Aruba/Juniper data with Marvis AI — to deliver autonomous networking competitive with Cisco Meraki.

Source: <https://www.theregister.com/networks/2026/05/09/hpe-drops-first-juniper-x-aruba-collab-self-driving-wi-fi/5235463>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Fortinet****2026-05-08****Platforms**

Fortinet Launches FEW-50G FortiExtender WAN 50G 5G Gateway for Edge Connectivity

Fortinet announced the FEW-50G FortiExtender WAN 50G, a high-throughput 5G gateway purpose-built to extend WAN connectivity for FortiGate NGFWs at the distributed edge. The device features two 5GE ports for low-latency, high-throughput connections, eight internal antennas for ruggedized deployment, and out-of-band console/USB management. Native integration with FortiOS extends the Fortinet Security Fabric to wireless WAN, while VRRP support and edge NAT failover preserve uptime during outages. AI-driven self-healing capabilities reduce manual monitoring, positioning the FEW-50G as a wireless WAN alternative to fiber for branch, retail, and industrial sites needing secure 5G uplinks.

Source: <https://www.fortinet.com/blog/secure-networking/the-future-of-connectivity>

EARNINGS**Fastly****2026-05-08****Application Delivery (ADCs)**

Fastly Posts Record Q1 2026 Results With 47% Security Growth, Raises Full-Year Guidance

Fastly reported record Q1 2026 revenue of \$173M (+20% YoY) with record gross margins of 65.1% non-GAAP, and moved from a year-ago loss to non-GAAP net income of \$19.1M. Security revenue jumped 47% to \$38.8M (22% of total), led by DDoS protection, bot management, and API discovery, while compute revenue rose 67% to \$8M boosted by AI workloads. RPO grew 63% to \$369M, net retention reached 113%, and Fastly raised full-year revenue guidance to \$710–725M. Management expects security and compute combined to exceed a \$200M annual run rate by late 2026.

Source: <https://investors.fastly.com/news-releases/news-release-details/fastly-announces-record-first-quarter-2026-financial-results>

CORPORATE RESTRUCTURING**Cloudflare**

2026-05-08

Platforms

Cloudflare Cuts 1,100 Jobs in "Agentic AI-First" Pivot Despite Record Q1 2026 Revenue

Cloudflare announced a roughly 20% workforce reduction — about 1,100 employees globally — as part of a pivot to an "agentic AI-first operating model," even as Q1 2026 revenue hit a record \$639.8M (+34% YoY) with remaining performance obligations above \$2.5B. Founders Matthew Prince and Michelle Zatlyn framed the layoffs as restructuring around AI rather than cost-cutting, citing AI usage up 600% in three months and AI-reviewed autonomous agents handling much of internal development. Departing staff receive base pay through year-end, extended healthcare, and equity vesting through August 15. Shares fell roughly 24% post-announcement; restructuring charges of \$140–150M are expected in Q2.

Source: <https://techcrunch.com/2026/05/08/cloudflare-says-ai-made-1100-jobs-obsolete-even-as-revenue-hit-a-record-high/>

PRODUCT POSITIONING**Citrix (NetScaler)**

2026-05-08

AI Data Delivery

NetScaler Pushes AI Gateway as Centralized Governance Layer for Enterprise AI Infrastructure

Citrix published guidance positioning NetScaler AI Gateway as the single control point enterprises need to manage AI traffic at scale. The piece argues that as AI adoption grows, the bottleneck is the surrounding environment — routing, policy, cost control, security, and visibility — not the models themselves. NetScaler AI Gateway delivers token-based rate limiting, token-latency load balancing across LLM backends, spillover routing, prompt management, and data redaction, extending NetScaler's proven application delivery infrastructure to AI inference traffic. The post reinforces Citrix's push to govern AI deployments centrally rather than through fragmented tooling, aligning with its Aidrien AI assistant and Protecto data-protection integration.

Source: <https://www.citrix.com/blogs/2026/05/08/ai-is-moving-fast-your-infrastructure-needs-to-keep-up/>

STRATEGY UPDATE**Cisco**

2026-05-08

Platforms

Cisco Reiterates Networking as Central to Platform Growth Strategy

Cisco executives, led by Chief Product Officer Jeetu Patel, doubled down on networking as the foundation of the company's platform strategy across AI, cloud, and security. Patel emphasized that "everything attaches to the network," highlighting investments in low-latency networking, integrated security, observability, optics, and a unified data platform. Since mid-2024, Cisco has merged networking, security, and collaboration under Patel and added oversight of the Common Hardware Group as part of CEO Chuck Robbins' restructuring to prioritize AI and cybersecurity. Analysts see the realignment reducing networking/security product overlap and positioning Cisco to capitalize on AI and hybrid-multicloud platform opportunities.

Source: <https://www.sdxcentral.com/analysis/cisco-touts-networking-as-central-to-success-key-for-platform-growth/>

M&A**Cisco**

2026-05-08

AI Security

Cisco to Acquire Astrix Security for AI Agent and Non-Human Identity Protection

Cisco announced its intent to acquire Astrix Security to bolster AI agent governance and non-human identity (NHI) security as autonomous agents proliferate in enterprises. Astrix specializes in securing API keys, service accounts, OAuth tokens, and AI agent credentials, offering discovery, lifecycle management, threat detection, and centralized secrets management. Cisco plans to integrate Astrix into Cisco Identity Intelligence and extend the capabilities to Secure Access and Duo IAM, aligning with its AI Defense, Zero Trust, and Splunk automation strategy. Cisco cited its AI Readiness Index showing only 24% of organizations have sufficient AI agent controls. Terms were not disclosed.

Source: <https://pulse2.com/cisco-to-acquire-astrix-security-to-expand-ai-agent-and-non-human-identity-security-capabilities/>

INDUSTRY REPORT**Check Point Software**

2026-05-08

Platforms**Check Point Cyber Security Report 2026 Calls for Prevention-First, Unified Hybrid Mesh Security**

Check Point's Cyber Security Report 2026 highlights a shift from technical exploitation to human-focused, AI-accelerated social-engineering attacks and argues cybersecurity must protect the entire user experience — email, voice, collaboration, browsers, and AI apps — not just networks and endpoints. The report promotes an end-to-end, hybrid mesh security model providing consistent policy, visibility, and controls across network, cloud, endpoint, and access layers, warning that fragmentation creates exploitable gaps. Ransomware is increasingly access-driven with lateral movement and exfiltration before encryption, making earlier prevention essential. Check Point emphasizes continuous exposure management and AI-driven defense to secure workspaces by default.

Source: <https://www.intelligentciso.com/2026/05/08/why-prevention-must-replace-detection-in-modern-cybersecurity/>

MAJOR CONTRACT**Akamai**

2026-05-08

AI Data Delivery**Akamai Signs Landmark \$1.8B Seven-Year AI Cloud Infrastructure Deal With Anthropic**

Akamai signed a seven-year, \$1.8 billion cloud-infrastructure deal with Anthropic — its largest customer contract ever — using its global edge network (4,300 locations, 700 cities, 130 countries) as a distributed AI inference compute platform. The consumption-based agreement is expected to recognize revenue starting Q4 2026, contributing \$20–25M that quarter and roughly 6% of 2026 revenue annually thereafter. Akamai's stock surged 27%, its largest single-day rally in 28 years. The deal validates Akamai's pivot from CDN to AI cloud, building on its Linode acquisition and Cloud Inference offering, and follows a separate \$200M four-year deal earlier in 2026.

Source: <https://thenextweb.com/news/akamai-anthropic-cloud-deal-ai-infrastructure>

REGIONAL EXPANSION**AWS**

2026-05-08

Platforms**AWS Service Catalog Expands to Asia Pacific (New Zealand) and Canada West (Calgary) Regions**

AWS expanded Service Catalog availability to two additional regions: Asia Pacific (New Zealand) and Canada West (Calgary). The service lets organizations create, govern, and share approved Infrastructure-as-Code products (CloudFormation, Terraform) for self-service deployment across AWS accounts via AWS Organizations. It supports launch and template constraints, product version management, and fine-grained IAM access control, enabling scalable governance for enterprises, system integrators, and MSPs. The expansion gives customers in those regions native control over standardized IaC catalogs and reinforces AWS's platform-governance posture for regulated and federated deployments.

Source: <https://mwpro.co.uk/blog/2026/05/08/aws-service-catalog-is-now-available-in-the-aws-asia-pacific-new-zealand-and-canada-west-calgary-regions/>